

The Glorified Body - 4

Matthew's Opened Graves Force the Resurrection Question

Locate two places: Romans 8 and 1 Corinthians 15. Put a marker in both. It is something that the resurrection limb came on the tree about two months before resurrection.

We will begin by reviewing Romans 8 so we can set a foundation for 1 Corinthians 15, the great resurrection chapter.

Last week we got into Matthew 27. It says the bodies of many of the saints who slept came out of the graves after His resurrection. When Jesus died, there was an earthquake, and it says the rocks were rent. The rocks He was talking about were the rocks in which many of the old prophets were entombed. The tomb Jesus was laid in was hewn out of solid rock. The rocks that were rent were letting some Old Testament saints come out.

It says the bodies of many of the saints who slept came out and appeared to many in Jerusalem.

Not many people know what to do with that verse. They do not know where to put it in their kingdom living, rapture, resurrection, tribulation, or end-time doctrine. But there was a resurrection on that day.

We have to figure out what happened when they were done appearing to everybody. Did they put them back in the grave, where they deteriorated and went back to dust, so Jesus could come get them when He comes for you and me? Or did their bodies fall off their spirits when it was time for Him to ascend into heaven, and people had to pick them up and bury them again?

How many times have you been buried twice?

Death is nothing to be afraid of. It is when your body gets too old to hang on to your spirit anymore, and one day you get up and it does not get up with you. That is how you are supposed to go home.

Spiritual Maturity Is Not Measured by How Long You Have Been Born Again

God said man's days would be one hundred and twenty years. Someone taught that when Israel was under violation of the law and the curse, they brought themselves under eighty years, but what God promised us was really one hundred and twenty. People occasionally make it. Two people in the United States recently died at one hundred and thirteen years old.

It is a shame to live one hundred and thirteen years and go home to the wrong place. You would think a person would learn something in that long.

Then again, your spiritual age is not counted by how long you have been born again. I know people who have been born again almost a hundred years and do not know anything. Then there are people born again five years, and they are winning nations.

It is not determined by how long you have been born again, but by how long it takes you to journey from milk to meat.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

The Inner Witness Makes Us Heirs of God and Joint Heirs With Christ

Let us review Romans 8. Begin with verse 15:

For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear; but ye have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father.

He is talking about a man who has been saved and born again. "Spirit of adoption" here is talking about your human spirit. Out of that new nature we cry, "Abba, Father."

The first mention of the Holy Spirit in the chapter is verse 16:

The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God.

The Spirit Himself bears witness with our human spirit that we are the children of God. But look what else this inner witness bears witness to:

And if children, then heirs; heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ...

If I am a child, then I am an heir. If I am an heir of God, then I am a joint heir with Christ.

Then Paul adds the stipulation:

If so be that we suffer with him, that we may be also glorified together.

This is all because of an inner witness that says I have been born again. I have become an heir of God and a joint heir with Jesus Christ.

The suffering He is talking about is a lifetime of bringing your flesh under subjection to the walk of the Spirit. The next verse shows it:

For I reckon that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed in us.

When will that glory be revealed? At the moment of glorification.

Joint Heirship Means One Resurrected Body Has Been Laid to Our Account

We often hear "joint heir with Jesus" and go straight to prosperity: "The cattle on a thousand hills belong to Him, therefore they belong to me." Someone else adds, "And I own the potatoes under them."

But Paul is talking about redemption. He says we are heirs of God and joint heirs with Christ. Joint heirs to what?

Jesus rose from the dead. He laid one resurrected body to your account, and you are a joint heir to it. All the other things are yours too, but this is what Paul was talking about in the mind of Christ.

He says the sufferings of a whole lifetime in this body, which has not yet been redeemed in the sense of glorification, are not worthy to be compared with that moment when your body goes from death to life and is glorified. A whole lifetime of telling your flesh, "Shut up. You are not reigning here. I am reigning here. I have the power of the Holy Spirit. I have been born again, and you are under subjection to that operation," is worth it.

At that moment, you get a building not made with hands, clothed upon from above. Anything you go through is not worthy to be compared to that moment of glorification, much less the reward that comes afterward.

You will say, "This is enough," and He will say, "I am just getting started, you sold-out little creature."

It is worth every hour of prayer, every hour of resisting the devil, every hour of resisting sin.

Creation Groans for the Manifestation of the Sons of God

Romans 8:19 says:

For the earnest expectation of the creature waiteth for the manifestation of the sons of God.

That is when we are glorified.

Some preach a doctrine called the manifested sons of God, an offshoot of kingdom-now teaching. Kingdom-now teaching says not to look at the eastern sky because Jesus will be glorified in any saint and we will take everything over here.

The manifestation Paul is talking about is when you get your glorified body and the adoption process is made complete.

Romans 8 says creation was made subject to vanity, or corruption, not willingly. God subjected Adam to it in hope of redemption. The creation itself will also be delivered from the bondage of corruption into the glorious liberty of the children of God.

The whole creation groans and travails in pain like a pregnant woman. Creation is pregnant with a new heaven and a new earth.

Romans 8:23 says:

And not only they, but ourselves also, which have the firstfruits of the Spirit...

We have the firstfruits of the Spirit. We are born again and filled with the Holy Spirit. We groan within this new nature while in the presence of imperfection, corruption, and a natural body capable of sin, waiting for the adoption process to be made complete.

When will it be made complete? At the redemption of our body.

Paul is not saying your body has not been redeemed. He has already said the inner witness says we are children, heirs, and joint heirs. Jesus has laid a body to our account. Our body has been redeemed and is waiting on our account.

We have death working in this body inherited from Adam. Because we have one on our account, we are waiting for the redemption of this body as it goes from corruptible, with death working in it, to a glorified body with no death in it, like Jesus' body.

We Are Saved in Hope While the Spirit Helps the Body's Weaknesses

Romans 8:24 says:

For we are saved by hope...

If you are waiting for Jesus to come back, or waiting to die, to see whether you are saved, you waited too long. If you are gambling on it, playing with sin, hoping you make it, that is not the hope Paul is talking about.

We know we are born again in our spirit, but we are saved in hope of the resurrected body. If we could see it, why would we yet hope for it? If we hope for what we do not see, then we wait for it with patience.

Then comes the part I really like. Look who He sent to help us wait:

Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities...

The infirmities here are the limitations imposed on us by this flesh. We are saved in hope of a glorified body, but meanwhile the Holy Spirit has come from heaven to help every weakness imposed on us by this flesh.

If you do not know how to pray as you ought, the Holy Spirit says, "Excuse Me. I know you are born again in a natural body, in an imperfect world full of sin, wars, death, and disease. I have come to help your weaknesses, you silly outfit. Learn how to depend on Me."

If sickness cleaves to your body and you are doing the Scriptures, confessing the Word, walking the floor, worshiping, and doing everything you know to do, but cannot get that thing off your body, the Holy Spirit has come to help that weakness. He knows the root of your problem, the beginning from the end, God's plan, His Word, and everything God has done for you. He can make intercession for the saints according to the will of God.

The Spirit Searches Each Heart and Prays the Individual Plan of God

Romans 8:27 says:

And he that searcheth the hearts knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit...

The Holy Spirit has the power to search every person's heart individually and independently at the same time and represent each one before the throne of grace. He can represent you as a total individual while representing me.

If I have the fullness of the Holy Spirit, who do you have? He is like the mainframe in heaven, and you are a little terminal with access to everything in His bank. How do you draw it out? With the computer language: tongues.

He that searches the hearts knows the mind, or plan, of God. He comes to search my heart already knowing God's whole plan for me in the body of Christ. That enables Him to make intercession for me according to the will of God.

Then we can know all things will begin to work together for the good of those who love God and are called according to His overall purpose. His individual will for you fits into His overall purpose. God uses you as He places you in and fulfills His perfect will in you.

This is why I sometimes say I wish the book of Roberson would appear at the end of Revelation. Then if I wanted to know where I was in my life, I could turn there and say, "Look, at sixty we were just about taking Tulsa. In the next ten years, Oklahoma got saved." But that book did not appear.

But it did appear when I was born again. The Holy Ghost stepped in, and He has that book in Him. He knows God's plan for me, so He is about the Father's business by praying His will in my life continually.

God's Foreknowledge Points Back to the Old Testament Saints Waiting for the Firstborn

Romans 8:28 says:

And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.

Then Paul shows the excellence of God's plan all the way back to Adam. When creation fell, God subjected the same in hope, because He had a plan to get them back.

Verse 29 says:

For whom he did foreknow, he also did predestinate to be conformed to the image of his Son...

This is before the cross. Actually, it goes all the way back to Adam. He predestinated those He foreknew to be conformed to the image of His Son, that His Son might be the firstborn among many brethren.

Predestination here does not mean God predestinated who would be saved and who would not. The predestination was in the wake of an event. They had to wait for the Firstborn, because before the Firstborn was born, there was no image to conform to.

Everyone from Adam to the cross whom He foreknew had to be predestinated to that single event: the Firstborn being born so they would have an image to conform to.

Romans 8:30 says:

Moreover whom he did predestinate, them he also called...

"Moreover" means that now that you understand the foundation, Paul can lay more on it. Whom He predestinated from Adam to the cross, He also called. There was not a single person He did not issue a call to. He tried to give everyone the form of salvation available in that day.

At the flood, the whole world was reduced to one family. God stopped and talked to the whole family through Noah with a simple plan: animals have become your food along with every herb bearing seed, but do not eat them with the blood in them because the life is in the blood and the blood is for atonement. Second, do not murder people.

Noah sacrificed one clean beast from the seven on the ark for the whole world. When his sons overspread the world, all they had to do was teach those two simple commandments and practice them. It was God's plan for salvation in that time.

By the time Abraham was one hundred years old, a Pharaoh was already beginning to believe he was God.

Those Whom God Justified at the Cross He Also Glorified

Romans 8:30 continues:

And whom he called, them he also justified: and whom he justified, them he also glorified.

When did He justify them? At the cross. They were predestinated to be conformed to His image, that He might be the Firstborn among many brethren. Those He foreknew, He predestinated. Those He called, He justified.

Now, who were the people who jumped out of the graves in Matthew 27? I have contemplated and meditated on this for a while, and nobody ever gave me a scriptural answer for those people.

People say, "They came out of Abraham's bosom." I say, "Yes, but it says their bodies."

If Jesus only resurrected their spirits and took them home with Him in a great procession, emptying Abraham's bosom and the promise from Noah and the promise that He would bruise Satan's head, then why does Matthew mention bodies?

Those He justified at the cross, He also glorified. Did He then put them back in the grave after they witnessed in Jerusalem? Did they say, "We scared a few people, appeared to a few, told them the resurrection is true. Now we are going back in the tomb, and He will put the rock back"?

Not likely.

Jesus told Mary not to touch Him yet because He had not yet ascended. Later He said, "Put your finger in My side." He was glorified. He laid one body to our account. One dispensation had passed, and the saints of that dispensation obviously went home with Him.

But I told God I had to see this in at least two places. The second is 1 Corinthians 15.

First Corinthians 15 Calls the Dead Saints the Firstfruits With Christ

Isaiah 26:19 says:

Thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise. Awake and sing, ye that dwell in dust...

Now go to 1 Corinthians 15. Paul declares the gospel: Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, He was buried, and He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures. He was seen by Cephas, then by the Twelve, then by more than five hundred brethren at once, then by James, then by all the apostles, and last of all by Paul.

Then Paul says:

Now if Christ be preached that he rose from the dead, how say some among you that there is no resurrection of the dead?

If there is no resurrection, Christ is not risen. If Christ is not risen, preaching is vain, faith is vain, and those who have fallen asleep in Christ have perished.

Then verse 20 says:

But now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept.

This word firstfruits is different from Romans 8, where we in this dispensation have the firstfruits of the Spirit while groaning for our resurrected body. Here, Christ is risen from the dead and become the firstfruits of those who had already died.

Then Paul goes all the way back to Adam:

For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead. For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive. But every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits; afterward they that are Christ's at his coming.

The question is the resurrection of the body. Christ has risen. Those dead from Adam to the cross are firstfruits. Afterwards, us at His coming.

What part of us is He coming back for? We will receive the same glorified body they received at the end of their dispensation.

Baptism for the Dead Assumes the Resurrection of the Body

Paul continues:

Then cometh the end...

He says Christ must reign until He has put all enemies under His feet, and the last enemy destroyed is death.

Then Paul asks:

Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all?

When you are baptized in water, it represents the death of the old man and the resurrection of the new as you come back up out of the grave. It represents spirit, soul, and body.

Paul's question was: if the dead are not going to rise and receive a body, why are they baptized for the dead?

Christians were dying at alarming rates. When Paul says he fought with beasts at Ephesus, believers were being put in arenas against beasts, and many converts lost their lives before they could be baptized. Evidently there was a custom in that day where friends stood in for them and

were baptized in their place.

Paul says:

If the dead rise not, let us eat and drink; for to morrow we die.

In other words, if there is no resurrection, just have fun in your sins. But he says:

Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners. Awake to righteousness, and sin not...

The Dead in Christ Come With Him and Yet Rise First

Paul then returns to the debate:

But some man will say, How are the dead raised up? and with what body do they come?

The whole subject of the chapter is the resurrection of the body. That is why Paul divides it into dispensations: every man in his own order; first Christ and the firstfruits, all those dead from Adam to the cross; then us who belong to Him in this dispensation at His coming.

In 1 Thessalonians 3:13 Paul says:

To the end he may stablish your hearts unblameable in holiness before God... at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ with all his saints.

First Thessalonians 4:14 says:

For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him.

Then Paul says:

We which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent them which are asleep.

The Greek means we will not precede them. We will not rise or be glorified before them.

For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout... And the dead in Christ shall rise first: Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds...

How can the dead in Christ rise first if they are coming back with Him?

First Corinthians says we who are alive and remain will go from corruptible to incorruptible at the sound of the trump, in the twinkling of an eye. But the others are coming back with Him, and they will rise first.

When you think the firstfruits who slept were not resurrected, then you must explain who came out of the graves when the rocks split in Matthew.